Appendix 2: Team Contract (i.e. Team Organization)

Contents

Step 1: Get to Know Another 2
Step 2: Team Culture. Clarify the Group's Purpose and Culture Goals. 3
Step 3: Time Commitments, Meeting Structure, and Communication 4
Step 4: Determine Individual Roles and Responsibilities 5
Step 5: Agree to the above team contract 6

Step 1: Get to Know One Another. Gather Basic Information.

Task: This initial time together is important to form a strong team dynamic and get to know each other more as people outside of class time. Consider ways to develop positive working relationships with others, while remaining open and personal. Learn each other's strengths and discuss good/bad team experiences. This is also a good opportunity to start to better understand each other's communication and working styles.

Team Member Name	***Strengths each member bring to the group***	***Other Info***	***Contact Info***
Brenna Wheaton	- Organization - Front End programming		757-300-7278 wheatonbl@vcu.edu
Brandon Hening	- Statistical background - Effective constructive criticism - Team communication		804-539-4832 heningbm@vcu.edu
Benjamin Karp	- Communicating - Back end / ERD design		804-213-6367 Benjamin Karp

Other Stakeholders	***Notes***	***Contact Info***
Oliver Henley	*Adacore, mentor/client*	henley@adacore.com
Ahmet Sonmez	Faculty Advisor	sonmeza@vcu.edu

Step 2: Team Culture. Clarify the Group's Purpose and Culture Goals.

Task: Discuss how each team member wants to be treated to encourage them to make valuable contributions to the group and how each team member would like to feel recognized for their efforts. Discuss how the team will foster an environment where each team member feels they are accountable for their actions and the way they contribute to the project. These are your Culture Goals (left column). How do the students demonstrate these culture goals? These are your Actions (middle column). Finally, how do students deviate from the team's culture goals? What are ways that other team members can notice when that culture goal is no longer being honored in team dynamics? These are your Warning Signs (right column).

Resources: More information and an example Team Culture can be found in the Biodesign Student Guide "Intentional Teamwork" page (webpage | PDF)

Culture Goals	***Actions***	***Warning Signs***
Commitment	- Show up time for meetings - Be prepared - Complete your tasks - Respond in a reasonable amount of time	-Not showing up to classes/meetings without communicating -Not responding to messages in discord in a reasonable amount of time -Other team members can reach out if there are any miscommunications/issues
Trust	- Rely on each other - Be accountable	–Not doing their part of the work in a reasonable amount of time -Other team members can ask them if they need help/reach out to advisor if they still don't do any work
Constructive Communication	- Be direct, but open - Be respectful and Positive	-Being rude or demeaning if there is an issue/mistake -Be polite and say things in a kinder way
Collaboration	- Work together - Ask for help - Decide as a group	-One person making all of the decisions/not listening to other team member's input -Discuss together and come to a solution that everyone can work with

Step 3: Time Commitments, Meeting Structure, and Communication

Task: Discuss the anticipated time commitments for the group project. Consider the following questions (don't answer these questions in the box below):

- What are reasonable time commitments for everyone to invest in this project?
- What other activities and commitments do group members have in their lives?
- How will we communicate with each other?
- When will we meet as a team? Where will we meet? How Often?
- Who will run the meetings? Will there be an assigned team leader or scribe? Does that position rotate or will same person take on that role for the duration of the project?

Required: How often you will meet with your faculty advisor advisor, where you will meet, and how the meetings will be conducted. Who arranges these meetings?
See examples below.

Meeting Participants	***Frequency*** ***Dates and Times / Locations***	***Meeting Goals*** ***Responsible Party***
- Students	Mondays at 3:30pm	Go over work needed to be completed for the week Arranged by project manager
- Students, Client, Faculty Advisor	Wednesdays at 3:30pm / Google Meet	Check in with client. Arranged by client
- Students, Faculty Advisor	Fridays / Time varies weekly	Review work completed Arranged by project manager

Step 4: Determine Individual Roles and Responsibilities

Task: As part of the Capstone Team experience, each member will take on a leadership role, ***in addition to*** contributing to the overall weekly action items for the project. Some common leadership roles for Capstone projects are listed below. Other roles may be assigned with approval of your faculty advisor as deemed fit for the project. For the entirety of the project, you should communicate progress to your advisor specifically with regard to your role.

- **Before meeting with your team**, take some time to ask yourself: what is my "natural" role in this group (strengths)? How can I use this experience to help me grow and develop more?
- **As a group,** discuss the various tasks needed for the project and role preferences. Then assign roles in the table on the next page. Try to create a team dynamic that is fair and equitable, while promoting the strengths of each member.

Communication Leaders

Suggested: Assign a team member to be the primary contact for faculty advisor. This person will schedule meetings, send updates, and ensure deliverables are met.

Common Leadership Roles for Capstone

1. **Project Manager:** Manages all tasks; develops overall schedule for project; writes agendas and runs meetings; reviews and monitors individual action items; creates an environment where team members are respected, take risks and feel safe expressing their ideas.

Required: On Edusourced, under the Team tab, make sure that this student is assigned the Project Manager role. This is required so that Capstone program staff can easily identify a single contact person, especially for items like Purchasing and Receiving project supplies.

2. **Logistics Manager:** coordinates all internal and external interactions; lead in establishing contact within and outside of organization, following up on communication of commitments, obtaining information for the team; documents meeting minutes; manages facility and resource usage.
3. **Financial Manager:** researches/benchmarks technical purchases and acquisitions; conducts pricing analysis and budget justifications on proposed purchases; carries out team purchase requests; monitors team budget.
4. **Systems Engineer:** analyzes Client initial design specification and leads establishment of product specifications; monitors, coordinates and manages integration of sub-systems in the prototype; develops and recommends system architecture and manages product interfaces.
5. **Test Engineer:** oversees experimental design, test plan, procedures and data analysis; acquires data acquisition equipment and any necessary software; establishes test protocols and schedules; oversees statistical analysis of results; leads presentation of experimental finding and resulting recommendations.
6. **Manufacturing Engineer:** coordinates all fabrication required to meet final prototype requirements; oversees that all engineering drawings meet the requirements of machine shop or vendor; reviews designs to ensure design for manufacturing; determines realistic timing for fabrication and quality; develops schedule for all manufacturing.

Team Member	***Role(s)***	***Responsibilities***
Brenna Wheaton	Systems and Manufacturing Engineer	- Backend Software Development - Frontend Design
Brandon Hening	Testing Engineer, Financial Manager	- Overseeing project budget - Managing purchases - Acquiring data from project testing - Presenting statistical findings to other team members
Benjamin Karp	Project Manager, Logistics	- Develop schedules and agendas - Planning - Coordinate with advisor

Step 5: Agree to the above team contract

Team Member: Brenna Wheaton	*Signature: Brenna Wheaton*
Team Member: Benjamin Karp	*Signature: Benjamin Karp*
Team Member: Brandon Hening	*Signature: Brandon Hening*
Team Member:	*Signature:*
Team Member:	*Signature:*